

Forward plan — reading order and glossary

Canonical name: `01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md`
Date: 2026-06-25 (updated 2026-06-11 — symbol decoder)
From: COMPASS
To: Charles Levine
Purpose: Glossary and jargon decoder.
Print stack: use `Charles_reading_list.md` for the full ordered list (must-read #1–#6 vs reference #7–#13).
Advisor framing: Alex Gates = guidance · Dakota Murray = decision points (not automatic path changes).
Start here if lost: `Charles_reading_list.md` → this section (symbol decoder) → rest of glossary → read must-read #2–#6 in full.

Symbol systems — read this when § or # loses you

Agents reused § for three different things. That was never meant to be forward-facing. **Default rule:** if a doc does not say otherwise, `§N` = a section of the Word manuscript (`Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx` , Dakota Murray v03 spine, routed by `#10`).

The three (plus one) symbol systems

Symbol	Means	Example
<code>#NN</code>	Numbered reading-stack file in <code>3-Master_Plan/</code> or <code>5-Manuscript/</code>	<code>#07</code> = <code>07_Claim_language_guardrails.md</code>
<code>§N</code> (default)	Manuscript Word outline section (Dakota v03)	"Ink <code>§5</code> → <code>§1</code> → <code>§4</code> " = generative → empirical triad → tenure
<code>§N</code> in <code>#12</code> only	Staging prose section — different numbering	Staging <code>§4</code> = Predictions → paste into manuscript <code>§7</code> , not manuscript <code>§4</code>
<code>§X</code> inside one <code>.md</code> file	Subsection of that file only	<code>#07 §F</code> = prediction claims table row; <code>#06 §3</code> = non-requirements block

Trap we created: "Write `§4` predictions" in agent notes often meant staging `#12 §4` (Predictions) → manuscript `§7`. Manuscript `§4` is Academic Tenure Setting — completely different.

Manuscript § map (Word — what ink order uses)

§	Manuscript section (Dakota v03)	Primary ink source
<code>§1</code>	Empirical Observation (Army, basketball, tenure triad)	<code>#12 §2.2</code> + <code>§3.4</code>
<code>§2</code>	Why Might This Happen? (<i>B</i> vs <i>D</i>)	<code>#12 §2.1</code> + <code>#05</code>
<code>§3</code>	From Global Competition to Constrained Distinction	<code>#12 §2.1</code> + <code>#05</code>
<code>§4</code>	Academic Tenure Setting	<code>#12 §3.4</code> tenure + <code>#11</code> digest
<code>§5</code>	Minimal Generative Modeling	<code>#12 §2.3</code> + <code>§3.2</code>
<code>§6</code>	Mechanism Decomposition	<code>#12 §2.4</code>
<code>§7</code>	Predictions and Validation	<code>#12 §4</code> (staging)
<code>§8</code>	Network Science (deferred v1)	Keep Dakota text; defer
<code>§9</code>	Thoughts to Stimulate Feedback	Committee brief only

Your ink order (locked): manuscript `§5` → `§1` → `§4` first — generative POC, then empirical legs, then tenure. Open `#11` before manuscript `§4` (tenure), not before predictions.

Staging `#12 §` map (copy-from prose — not the same numbers)

Staging §	Topic	Goes to manuscript §
<code>§2</code>	Theory and framing	<code>§1–§3</code> , <code>§6</code>
<code>§3</code>	Methods	<code>§1</code> , <code>§4</code> , <code>§5</code>
<code>§4</code>	Predictions	<code>§7</code>
<code>§5</code>	Discussion and limitations	<code>§2</code> closing, <code>§6</code> , new Discussion

When an old note says "VECTOR `§3`" or "`§4` predictions," check whether it means staging `#12` or manuscript Word — use the table above.

Repo-only shorthands (never bare in docs meant for you)

Shorthand	Full pointer (first mention rule)
530	sports/530_sports_pipeline.ipynb — empirical panel + overlap (CELL 8)
537	sports/537_tier1_benchmark.ipynb — sort-and-chop falsification
538 / 538D	sports/538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb / sports/538D_development.ipynb
540	540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb — tenure Cox Layer B (pre-submission)
CELL 4D	Sub-block under CELL 4 in 538D — letter D, not four dimensions
D10	Export bundle — file list in #08

Numbered active docs (quick map)

#	File	Role
01	01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md	This file — glossary
02	02_Charles_decisions_locked.md	Your Tier 1 locks (already filed)
03	03_Where_we_are_now.md	Project status today
04	04_Project_story_plain_English.md	Plain-English story
05	../5-Manuscript/05_Model_Nesting_Note_v1.md	One ontology $L_{\text{net}} = B - D$
06	06_Generative_closure_checklist.md	SCOUT C1–C8 checklist
07	07_Claim_language_guardrails.md	What you may / may not claim
08	08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md	D10 bundle file list
09	09_Tenure_export_on_disk.md	Inference export numbers
10	../5-Manuscript/10_Manuscript_ink_map.md	Section routing for Word
11	../5-Manuscript/11_Dakota_feedback_decision_points.md	Dakota email → evaluate, not auto-follow
12	../5-Manuscript/12_Manuscript_staging_prose.md	Copy-from paragraphs
13	13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md	Pivotal framing (optional skim)
14	14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md	PD12 ladder relabel; B-lite closure (optional)

Long original names → obsolete/original_filenames/.

Returning after a break (June 2026) — use this path

Tier 1 already filed in 02_Charles_decisions_locked.md. Phase A exports done. **Do not re-litigate locks.**
Follow Charles_reading_list.md: must-read #1–#6 in full, then keep #7–#13 as reference while inking Word.

Deep-dive reading order (optional — original correspondence arc)

Use only if you want the full history behind the locks. **Not required** for manuscript inking.

Step	Document	Read for
0a	13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md	Pivotal perspectives
0b	docs/Menger/	Menger deep read (optional)
0	This file	Glossary
1	04_Project_story_plain_English.md	Plain-English story
2	20260615_1045_COMPASS_to_Charles_forward_plan_and_questions.md	Original action plan; that file’s §6–§7 question tiers (superseded by #02)
3	20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md	Alex PD12: four priorities
4	14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md	Ladder relabel; B-lite closure
5	07_Claim_language_guardrails.md	Claim discipline — §E, §F
6	06_Generative_closure_checklist.md	Green/yellow checklist

Skip for first pass: Round 1–5 correspondence in obsolete/; long overlap in 03_Where_we_are_now.md vs #04.

Two different “Tier” systems

Docs use Tier for two unrelated things. Check context.

A. Scientific tiers (story arc)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1	Phenomenon — inverted-U on LOO proxy (mostly done)
Tier 2	Minimal mechanism — generative POC; D10 packages it
Tier 2.5	Model-guided features — quality vs congestion (PD12)
Tier 3	Predictions — named candidates, not fully proven
Tier 4	Manuscript — write the paper

B. Question tiers (your decisions — obsolete forward plan §6)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1 questions	Answer first — unblocks SCOUT, PEER, VECTOR (items 1–10 in obsolete forward plan §6)
Tier 2 questions	Softer prose/methods — OK to say “use agent defaults” (§6 items 11+ in that file)
Tier 3+	Alex meeting, AWS, optional routes — not blocking this week

Tier 1 question IDs (memorize these five blocks):

- **SCOUT**: Q-SCOUT-9 (folder path), Q-D10 (go on export bundle)
- **PEER**: C1 (OpenAlex tiers), C2 (CSV names)
- **VECTOR**: C12–C13 (predictions + outline), V1–V3 (manuscript priority + timing)
- **COMPASS**: Q-DEFAULTS (accept Tier 2 defaults?)

Status: Answered in 02_Charles_decisions_locked.md.

Rung / ladder (plain English)

Not a code pipeline. Steps in the paper argument, in order (see also #05 §3, #14 Q1):

Rung 1	Phenomenon	→ inverted-U exists (Army, basketball; tenure preliminary)
Rung 2	Minimal model	→ talent-only fails; congestion-in-score POC (basketball)
Rung 2.5	Model-guided feats	→ quality vs congestion columns (mostly built; D10 exports)
Rung 3	Predictions	→ #1 near-threshold, #2 Λ – candidates, not fully validated
Rung 4	Manuscript	→ ink Word under Path II

Ladder = climb these rungs when writing; do not jump from “we found a curve” to “submit the paper” without the middle steps Alex (PD12) cares about.
Rung 2.5 was added in the June PD12 reassessment because Alex’s ladder includes “theory proposes new measurements” (Priority 3) — not only phenomenon + minimal sim + predictions. It names what SCOUT already built (poolq_loo vs crowding_smooth, near-threshold export).

Paths (manuscript architecture)

Path	Meaning	v1?
Path II (locked)	3 empirical inverted-U legs + one basketball generative POC; honest axis mismatch	Yes
Path I	Generative sim must match LOO pool-quality axis bin-for-bin	No — parallel / post-v1

Path II = Charles’s “manuscript-first” lock (2026-06-11): write the paper with honest layering; do not block the draft on generative LOO bin-for-bin match or 3-domain parametric fit.

B-lite closure — where the name came from

Origin: COMPASS label in 14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md Question 2 (2026-06-15), after you re-read Alex’s PD12 guidance. Agents needed a word for “strong enough for Alex, weak enough for v1.”
Not Alex’s term — he describes priorities; B-lite is our shorthand for the adopted closure standard:

Option	Standard	v1?
A	Model reproduces the phenomenon	Too weak
B (full)	+ measurable + prediction + parametric identifiability across domains	Too strong — pulls PD12 Priority 1
B-lite (adopted)	Phenomenon + minimal mechanism POC + ≥1 model-guided measurement exported + ≥1 prediction readout + honest limits + D10 frozen bundle	Yes — matches Priority 3 without new science

Plain English: B-lite = “show the mechanism can work, export the measurements the model motivates, name the predictions, state the limits, freeze the folder” — not “identify every parameter in Army + basketball + tenure.”

Where it lives operationally: `06_Generative_closure_checklist.md` C1–C8 + D10 bundle (`#08`). **Five greens** (C1–C4 + C7, optionally C8) = B-lite satisfied for basketball generative leg.

Predictions #1 and #2 (Charles clarification)

Agents locked **two prediction slots** for manuscript structure — **not** “two proven results.”

#	Name	Empirical status today
#1	Near-threshold heterogeneity	Candidate. Exploratory export from <code>sports/538D_development.ipynb</code> CELL 4D → <code>heterogeneity_ventiles_top_tail.png</code> (<code>#08</code>); not formal cross-domain test.
#2	Peak shift with Λ	Placeholder / prose hook. No finished Λ figure in repo.

Do say: “primary prediction **directions.**”
Do not say: “predictions are fully validated across all settings” (see `07_Claim_language_guardrails.md` §F).

Shorthand glossary

Term	Plain English
COMPASS	Cross-project planner — sequencing, not domain code
CODA	Army agent
SCOUT	Basketball agent
PEER	Tenure agent
VECTOR	Your online ChatGPT Scholar agent (manuscript voice); also used as repo role label
PD12	Alex Gates paper-directions meeting, 2026-05-20
STANDING BY	Agent done debating; waiting on Charles only
Correspondence experiment	Rounds 1–5 agent mail — complete (in <code>obsolete/</code>)
LOO	Leave-one-out — peer pool excluding yourself
<code>poolq_loo</code>	LOO teammate pool quality (main empirical x-axis)
<code>crowding_smooth</code>	LOO congestion — density of viable peers above threshold
Λ (Lambda)	Global distinction capacity (slots, boards, draft picks)
D10	SCOUT export script — figures/tables in <code>08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md</code>
Claim table	<code>07_Claim_language_guardrails.md</code>
B-lite closure	COMPASS coinage (2026-06-15, #14 Q2) : phenomenon + minimal mechanism POC + model-guided measurement exported + prediction readout + honest limits + D10 — not full 3-domain identifiability (“B full”)
Axis table	Maps model quantity ↔ empirical column ↔ setting (in D10 bundle)
Wang structure	Paper arc: phenomenon → mechanism → predictions
Wang move	Predict something you did not use to find the curve
Layer B	Tenure Cox cells 10–12 in <code>540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb</code> — pre- submission , not draft blocker
Dakota Murray v03	Committee RTF spine + <code>10_Manuscript_ink_map.md</code>
Generative POC	Small sim showing talent-only fails and congestion bends curves
POC	Same as generative POC — proof of concept (not “model finished”)
Pool mean	Whole-roster average — generative readout axis (≠ LOO axis)
hook	Named attachment point — where an idea lands (manuscript §7 / staging <code>#12</code> §4 for predictions; repo file; Menger chapter) before proof exists; not clickbait
PD12 guidance	Alex’s May 20 meeting summary: <code>20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md</code> — not <code>14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md</code> (COMPASS ladder memo)
axis mismatch	Empirical v1 uses LOO pool quality ; generative POC reads out on pool mean — state honestly, don’t pretend they match
scope discipline	Don’t claim more than one domain/table/mechanism actually proves (e.g. no “six causal channels estimated” from one MBB table)
sort-and-chop	Naive pool model: rank 1–N, cut into disjoint equal bins — falsified by overlap plots (<code>sports/537_tier1_benchmark.ipynb</code>)
overlap / sorting	Real pools are assortative but overlapping talent ecologies — your distinctive empirical finding (<code>sports/530_sports_pipeline.ipynb</code> CELL 8)
<code>538D</code>	Notebook <code>sports/538D_development.ipynb</code> — generative lab (CELL 10 POC + CELL 4D heterogeneity); D = development variant of 538, not “4D analysis”
CELL 4D	Sub-cell under CELL 4 in <code>538D</code> (after 4A/4B/4C) — near-threshold heterogeneity plot; letter suffix, not four dimensions. Export: <code>heterogeneity_ventiles_top_tail.png</code> (D10, <code>#08</code>)
#03 ... #14	Shorthand for numbered files in <code>3-Master_Plan/</code> (e.g. <code>#07</code> = claim guardrails)
SCOUT C1	Talent-only generative baseline fails — see <code>06_Generative_closure_checklist.md</code>
PEER C1	OpenAlex HIGH+MEDIUM tiers for tenure — see <code>02_Charles_decisions_locked.md</code>

When a term isn’t here: ask in chat or add to `20_feedback_questions_and_observations.md` — COMPASS should expand this table when you report a miss.

COMPASS shorthand policy (chat + docs)

Shorthand keeps agents aligned; **you** should not need to decode every seventh word.

Do	Don't
Use <code>#07</code> , LOO, PD12, etc. when we've defined them in this file	Assume you remember every agent coinage from June correspondence
On first use in a chat reply , add a 3–8 word gloss or <code>(see #01)</code>	Stack three undefined shorthands in one sentence
Name the file when citing guidance (<code>20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md</code>)	Say "PD12 guidance" with no pointer if context is ambiguous
Notebook/cell cites: <code>sports/538D_development.ipynb</code> CELL 4D + export path — not bare "4D" or "CELL 4D" alone	Assume you know which of dozens of notebooks agents mean
Put recurring lookups in this glossary	Send you on archaeology through <code>obsolete/</code> without saying so

Your feedback (2026-07): ~1 in 7 shorthands still sends you looking — treat that as a bug; expand `#01` or gloss inline when you flag it.

What to do after reading (June 2026)

- 1. Open `5-Manuscript/Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx`
- 2. Ink **manuscript §5 → §1 → §4** (generative → empirical triad → tenure) using `#10`, `#12`, `#08`
- 3. Before **manuscript §4** (tenure), open `#11` — not staging §4 (predictions → manuscript §7 later)
- 4. Message COMPASS: **"back in the game"**

Glossary companion to `Charles_reading_list.md`.